

**John Terry**

**Intermediate Team Faculty**

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**Grade 5 Social Studies, Science, and Religion  
Syllabus: 2026-2027**

Welcome to Grade 5. This syllabus is intended for you, the student, to develop a greater understanding of what we will cover, what is expected of you, and what you can expect from me. For Social Studies, my primary focus will be to complete this year with all students developing a love for and grade-level understanding of US history, developing critical thinking skills, and using historical evidence to formulate an argument. For Religion, my hope is that students further develop their faith in God, the church and its teaching and finally, to develop moral reasoning and decision-making. And for Science, that students build confidence and mastery through study and hands-on labs and experiments that will make the transition to 5th grade Science seamless.

~~Mary, Star of the Sea School Mission Statement: Nurture, Unite, Inspire. At Mary, Star of the Sea~~

Nurture, Unite, Inspire. We are committed to nurturing each child's curiosity, uniting our classroom in respect and collaboration, and inspiring every student to grow in knowledge, faith, and wonder for the world around them.

**Social Studies Course Overview:** Students will be learning about the history of people in North America beginning with the first indigenous tribes and ending with Manifest Destiny and the expansion of the United States across the continent. Students will learn about important themes throughout our history, engage in research and analysis of historical events, and participate in cross-curricular projects using other subjects such as English and Art.

**Textbook:** MyWorld Interactive (Social Studies)

**Assessment:** Homework (20%)  
Quizzes (20%)  
Classwork and participation (30%)  
Tests (30%)

|                    |           |                                                                                                          |
|--------------------|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Curriculum:</b> | Quarter 1 | Unit 1-The First Americans<br>Unit 2-Age of Exploration<br>Unit 3-Settling the Colonies in North America |
|                    | Quarter 2 | Unit 4-Life in the Colonies<br>Unit 5-The American Revolution                                            |
|                    | Quarter 3 | Unit 6-A New Nation<br>Unit 7-Life in the Young Republic                                                 |
|                    | Quarter 4 | Unit 8-Westward Expansion<br>Unit 9-Civil War and Reconstruction                                         |

**Religion Course Overview:** Students in Grade 5 Religion at MSOS will grow in their relationship with God and gain an understanding of the importance of each individual as part of the Church's mission.

**Textbook:** Blest Are We: Faith in Action

**Assessment:** Homework/Classwork (20%)  
Projects (30%)  
Tests (30%)  
Quizzes (10%)  
Participation (10%)

**Curriculum:** Quarter 1: The Sacraments  
Quarter 2: Initiation & The Apostles Creed  
Quarter 3: Eucharist & The Last Supper  
Quarter 4: Forgiving & Living as Christians

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**Science Course Overview:** The three main areas of science instruction that will be covered are Life Science, Earth Science, and Physical Science. Our lessons include standards-based content with inquiry-based activities. The Scientific method will be a focus of our learning. Students will be provided with hands-on experiences to explore the lesson concept. Students will formulate questions that can be answered through investigations.

**TEXTBOOKS:** HMH into Science (*Science*)

**Assessment** Homework (20%)  
Quizzes (20%)  
Classwork and participation (30%)  
Tests (30%)

**Curriculum:**

Quarter 1     **Engineering and Technology**  
Identifying problems, Improving technology, Technology, engineering, Improving technology over time, How do engineers solve problems, Design process

**Begin Unit 2 Matter**  
Measuring mass and volume, Evidence of matter, Particles

Quarter 2     **Finish Unit 2 Matter**  
Many properties of matter, How heat affects matter, Matter can change, When matter changes  
Conservation of matter

**Begin Unit 3 Energy in organisms**  
Plants use energy and matter. What plants need to grow, how organisms make food, Organisms' growth, change, and regrowth, Animal energy, Energy moves between organisms.

Quarter 3     **Energy and Matter in Ecosystems**  
How organisms interact in ecosystems, how the environment affects organisms, living things and their environment, Balance in an ecosystem, introduced and invasive species, Food webs and food chains, Competition in an ecosystem

Quarter 4     **Earth interactions and resources**  
Earth materials form systems-Interactions of systems shape landforms. Earth's major systems, Natural events on our planet, the Water cycle, Water stores heat, Earth's resources and human activities, How to get resources, Using resources

Parents, please note: You will have access to my electronic gradebook via your Beehively account, which will be a primary method of communicating your child's academic performance. ***It will be assumed that you have seen all grades and missing assignments that are entered in Beehively.***

**Homework Policy:** Homework that is given will not be for students to explore new concepts. Homework will strictly be to reinforce concepts that have already been taught in class, including research for projects. It is used as more of a "completion" grade.

Your children's teachers will work together to ensure that the students receive a balanced homework regime aimed at creating a positive learning environment that nurtures students' intellectual growth.

**Communication:** The best way to communicate with a teacher is by email. Students will be sent home with a white envelope on Tuesdays that has updated work and various other documents regarding events at school.

Updates will also be sent out via Beehively, which is our new electronic communication and grading portal. Announcements posted to Beehively will be sent directly to your email as well as important upcoming assignments and events.

#### **Materials:**

Composition Notebook (3)

Pencil, colored and regular

Red Pen

Highlighter

HMH Textbook

Headphones, mouse

There will be times we do STEM projects that will require additional materials to be brought in, such as soda bottles, construction paper, balloons, etc.

**Late Work/Extra Credit:** All late work must be turned in within one week it was assigned. Students will receive 70% on late work turned in. Extra credit is not offered. However, during the last week of each quarter, students may turn in any missing or incomplete work for partial credit (60%)

10% will be taken off of project grades for late submissions